

1943, January 29

Mr. James M. Casey - Page 2

If I am not mistaken, I gave a copy of the above referred- to started-description to Mary and Helena when these two cousins were visiting me on their way to Montreal, Quebec, etc, a few years back. At all events when I get back to St. Bonaventure's I shall try and send you a copy of the same; for I am sure someone made a number of copies for me, seemingly anxious that even at that time I should finish it up as a worth-while whole. It will hardly be objectionable if we review a little of the description made before. So I'll start with our course of activity after the Solemn Mass of the Jubilee in Prescott (Wis.). Sunday August 22, the Octave of the Assumption, on which feast itself we had the first celebration in Superior, 165 miles to the N.

Needless to say the neat little Church of St. Joseph looking down the rear on the Mississippi about 400 feet below, was filled to capacity. Fr. Maurice J. and I had gone out to St. Mary's Big River the night before; Dean Conley having driven us down from St. Paul via River Falls, and Hudson. (Hardly necessary now to say who same D.C. was. It might've added somewhat to the already exquisit pleasure of the trip had we recognized in him what we only surmised at the time, a future nephew-in-law and ... Br. Jim's third son). We had offered our holy Masses out at said old St. Mary's where we older ones first went to holy Mass and to Catechism instructions, down to Maurice receiving First Holy Communion. We took the first scheduled Mass while the Rev. Pastor went to his mission several miles distant. I was inclined to envy him the privilege but felt that it was coming to him rather than to his younger brother but I quite enjoyed his nice little sermon. After our thanksgiving, etc, the pastor having returned reshot us down the Prescott-Elsworth Highway and before we knew it we were in the St. Joseph's sacristy vesting for solemn services, Rt. Rev. Bishop Griffin present.

Fr. Solanus had been appointed several months before or about the same as appointed to give the sermon. It was his first time before a Bishop and I hardly remember if it was satisfactory. For himself it was far from what it ought to have been. Perhaps it was fortunate that he did not foresee what caused him quite a dissapointment before the Mass was over - No one except the Rev. Celebrant received Holy Communion:Otherwise everything went off without a hitch. Deo Gratias. But what a crowd waiting outside after the celebration in Church! One Mangan after another each with a family. Tim. and one or two of the others I recognized. And among the many others the senior of them all, now the 98 year-old Bill Betzel, if he still lives. He was 93 then, and his wife who was blind and an invalid 87 years-old wished to see us. So after dinner we visited her and she wept when we gave her our blessing. From Betzel's we went over several blocks and prayed the rosary at the wake of a little Bower boy, a distant in-law drowned in Chicago a few days before. The child's mother, Kathleen, was a niece of John's first Wife Nellie (O'Brien); May their dear souls rest in peace!